Drama teacher and cover plan

Creative Arts · BUILD · Spring 2 Week 1 · Monday 22 February 2027 · P5

Lesson

A story in three still pictures

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Year A · Explore · Theme Resilience & Change

Weekly outcome

Use freeze-frame/role-play to tell a story.

Today I can

I can show first, next and last.

I can choose a pose or direct one.

I can keep one real choice in my arts log.

Prepare

For three to four pupils: books or arts logs and pencils.

Clear a safe acting area. Keep chairs available for seated work.

No props, costumes, devices or sound equipment are needed.

Retain the three-part plans and dated observations for the next lesson.

Cover route

Read each stage aloud and model the lost prop sequence in three still poses. Use no props. Let pupils act seated or direct an adult. Plan, rehearse, change one pose and keep the pupil-confirmed arts-log entry. Share only with an agreed audience. The seven stage times total 40 minutes.

Drama teaching sequence

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Arrival 3 minutes

Say: Choose how to join in. We will tell a made-up story. You can sit, direct me or try a pose. Our open hand means stop.

Look for: Every pupil has a participation choice and knows the stop cue.

Fallback: Offer two choices: direct me or use one hand. A pupil may watch first.

Check and response: Acting, directing and a seated pose are all valid. Watching first is a preparation choice; record a later contribution accurately.

Starter 3 minutes

Say: My empty hands and look show a missing prop. My point shows an idea. Can we tell which comes first? These are invented signs, not rules about feelings.

Look for: Pupils notice a concrete feature and link it to a story part.

Fallback: Show the two poses seated. Ask the pupil to point to first.

Check and response: Looking at the empty shelf can begin the story. A point can show a plan. Accept another clear order if the pupil explains it.

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I do 6 minutes

Say: I show three still pictures. First I look at the empty shelf. Next I point into a box. Last I hold an imaginary prop and smile. I hold each pose for two seconds and relax. I try the last pose facing away, then facing you. Facing you makes my choice easier to see.

Look for: Adult models a complete three-part invented story, a comfortable freeze and one deliberate improvement.

Fallback: Mime with hands on a table or describe each part while pointing to three spaces.

Check and response: The problem is a missing prop. Looking in a box is the action. Finding it is the ending. Ask: Which pose shows the end? Check before moving on.

We do 6 minutes

Say: Let us use the lost prop story. You choose where I look first. A partner or adult can be the friend. We move only at walking pace and do not touch. After each cue, relax. If the ending is unclear, change one hand or face direction.

Look for: Each pupil chooses a story detail. The group rehearses a shared cue and improves one pose.

Fallback: One pupil directs the adult through three seated poses. Ask the next pupil to choose a different final pose.

Check and response: A clear end might show the found prop. If pupils cannot order the parts, return to two parts: lost, found; then add the search. This is the hinge decision.

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Create 14 minutes

Say: Work in a pair, or in a small group with an adult. Choose the lost prop or a folded sheet that now fits. Give each person a pose or a directing job. Take turns choosing. Rehearse, ask one viewer what they saw, then change one pose. I will note your real choice.

Look for: Each pupil makes or directs an intentional pose. The sequence has a beginning, action and ending, with one tested change.

Fallback: Use three small sketches or table-top hand poses. Adult acts only the pupil directions. A pupil may show just two parts first, then choose a third.

Check and response: Example only: empty hands, point in box, hold found prop. A new safe invented sequence is equally valid. Record what the pupil actually did, not the example.

Review 5 minutes

Say: Choose a partner or a private adult audience. The viewer says what they saw, then asks the maker to confirm. Keep feedback about the story. In the last two minutes, return chairs safely and store the plan.

Look for: Pupil shares a choice with an agreed audience and hears one specific observation.

Fallback: Adult describes the directed pose and asks the pupil to confirm the intended part.

Check and response: Useful feedback: I saw you point in the box. That helped me see the search. Avoid guessing private feelings.

Drama evidence and teaching checks

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Exit 3 minutes

Say: Show your plan or describe your real pose. I can write your words and read them back. You can change them. We will use this sequence again tomorrow, or make a fresh one if needed.

Look for: Dated entry records the pupil role, chosen pose, reason and actual support.

Fallback: Offer first, next or last as choices. Scribe only the confirmed response.

Check: Example only: I pointed in the box to show a search. Next time I will face the viewer.

Evidence and review

Keep the actual story plan, dated observation and pupil-confirmed arts-log words. Record the contribution and help used. A photograph or recording is optional and follows local consent procedures. Model examples are never entered as pupil evidence.

Misconceptions

A freeze-frame means hold still for a long time - Hold a comfortable pose for two seconds, then relax. Seated or hand poses count.

A good story needs real events from my life - Use an invented prop or folded sheet story. No personal disclosure is needed.

The loudest actor tells the clearest story - A clear pose, space and order can tell the story in silence.

Questions

foundation: Which part comes first?

middle: What helps us see the change?

higher: Which choice makes the story clearer, and why?

Drama access and safety

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Safety

Clear bags and chairs from the acting area. Mark personal space by agreement; no touch, lifting, chasing, falls, climbing, weapons or thrown objects. Mime props. A still pose may be seated and lasts only a comfortable few seconds.

Emotional and sensory access

Agree an open-hand stop signal and a quiet return cue. Keep voices at talking level. Allow pass, private sharing and a calm pause. Do not use sudden noises, personal stories or forced eye contact.

Planned adaptations

Cognition And Learning: Show one story part at a time. Rehearse first, next and last. Use two choices and fade prompts.

Communication And Interaction: Offer point, sign, speech, drawing or a pupil-directed adult. Give thinking time. Repeat the pupil choice for confirmation.

Semh: Use invented roles. Agree audience and opt-out before rehearsal. Give each pupil a real choice without a public performance demand.

Sensory And Physical: Offer seated, silent or directing roles. Keep walking pace and safe personal space. Stop if a pose is uncomfortable.

Eal: Plan in any language. Show freeze, move and share with gestures. Accept labels, drawings or an oral response before a full sentence.

The award and evidence

Both pathways work at Explore. Retain actual participation, exploration, creation and sharing evidence for the award. These lessons do not certify completion. Optional next level work in GROW is additional.

A pause, a request for help or a new plan can show resilience. Pupils do not need to act out real distress or tell a personal story.